

A scan is only worth what the walk was worth. A room walked wrong cannot be fixed afterwards — it has to be walked again.

01 Where to stand

4–6 ft OFF THE WALL — AIM HERE	3–15 ft USABLE BAND. EDGES DRIFT	16 ft RANGE CEILING · 5 M
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Why 4–6 ft: the whole wall run has to be in frame, including where it meets the floor. Hug the wall and the sensor only ever sees a patch — no long straight edge to fit a plane to. Stand too far back in a big room and the far wall is past range. Minimum working distance is ~8–10 in.

02 How to hold it

Height	Chest height, tilted slightly down.
Aim	So the camera sees where the wall meets the floor . That joint is the strongest signal the scanner has for finding the room's outline. Pointing level at blank drywall gives it almost nothing to work with.
Grip	Two hands. Elbows in. Smooth beats fast.

03 How to walk it

- 1 Start in a corner, never mid-wall.**
Starting mid-wall slows the tracker's orientation and increases drift from the first second.
- 2 Move your body, not your arms.**
Walk the perimeter at a slow walking pace, sweeping gently side to side, camera angled inward toward the middle of the room. Standing still and panning is what produces drift.
- 3 Pause a beat at every corner.**
Corners are where the geometry gets pinned down. Rushing them is the most common cause of a room that will not close.
- 4 Finish where you started.**
Returning to known ground is what lets the tracker correct everything it accumulated on the way round. This is the single biggest quality lever on the card.
- 5 Turn the lights on.**
LiDAR does not care about darkness. The camera tracking that stitches it all together does.

04 The limits — these are where it breaks

Under 5 min	Per room. Longer sessions drift, the device heats up, and tracking degrades.
Under 30 × 30 ft	Apple's recommended maximum scan area. Bigger spaces get split into separate scans.
One room per scan	Do not try to walk the house in one go. Each room is its own capture.
Glass & mirrors	Reflective surfaces cut reliability. Note where they are rather than trusting them.

IF THE APP TELLS YOU SOMETHING, IT WINS

RoomPlan gives live feedback — "Move farther away", "Slow down", "More light". It is reading your actual session; this card is not. Follow the screen over this page, every time.

05 The tape log — the most valuable thing you do

A scan on its own has no ground truth. Tape three or four walls per room and write the numbers here — it turns "accurate within a published range" into "accurate within a figure we measured."

ROOM	WHICH WALL	TAPE SAYS	SCAN SAYS	NOTES

MEASURE THE SAME WALL TWICE

Once at the start of the scan and once at the end. If the two readings differ, that is **drift** — a different problem from sensor error, and it gets fixed differently.

06 Also worth writing down

Scan time per room — bumping five minutes on a normal room explains a lot of drift on its own. **Which device**, and whether more than one was used on the same room. **What it got visibly wrong** — a double door read as one, a closet swallowed, a wall split in two, an angled wall squared off. Those are the failure modes worth catching now rather than in six months.

07 When it goes wrong

WHAT HAPPENED	WHAT TO DO
The room will not close	Walk it again in the opposite direction before giving up. Known ground from a new angle lets the tracker correct itself.
A wall is missing entirely	Too close, or held level rather than tilted down. Re-walk it at 4–6 ft, camera angled at the floor joint.
Tracking jumped or reset	Stop and start the room again. A scan that lost tracking is not worth correcting afterwards.
Device got hot	Scan was too long. Split the space up and let the device cool.

08 Scan the simple room first

Not a preference — it is the control case. Without it a bad result cannot be diagnosed at all.

SIMPLE ROOM	AWKWARD ROOM	WHAT IT TELLS YOU
Accurate	Accurate	Technique and device are sound. Build on it.
Accurate	Wrong	Geometry complexity — that is the solver's job, not yours.
Wrong	Wrong	Technique or the device itself. Fix this before anything else matters.

What to send back: one export file per room, scanned separately — not merged. Two rooms that share a wall are worth far more than two rooms at opposite ends of the house. JSON above all other formats; DXF and PDF too if the app offers them. Plus this page, filled in.